

The Silent Orchard

by Christine La bella — Sample Chapter

This is placeholder sample text for *The Silent Orchard*. Replace this file with a real excerpt from the novel — typically the first chapter or first few pages, exported or printed to PDF.

The orchard had belonged to her grandmother, and before that, to no one in particular — just rows of trees that had grown wild long enough to seem permanent. Elena stood at the gate for a long moment before she let herself in.

It was the kind of morning that felt like it was holding its breath.

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Placeholder sample — replace [downloads/the-silent-orchard-sample.pdf](#) with the real excerpt.